

left no doubt to the other entrants into the touch screen arena that Apple had developed an interface universally understood and liked, which put people at ease with their instrument. Most followed into its footsteps with minor changes here and there but stuck to the basic layouts and gesture recognition as the iPhone and this same user interface passed onto almost all tablets we use today. This compact, feature-packed gadget, to date, remains a milestone for this technology. Its popularity is a testament to what a user wanted from a phone.

Once it set the standards in the mobile industry, Apple concentrated elsewhere, and gave the world its very first iPad in 2010. Most people argue this wasn't revolutionary technology in itself, as various versions of the tablet had been in use for a long time by then. The critics were silenced when Jobs in his characteristic style showed the world that till you actually haven't used a particular product, you wouldn't even know you needed it. Its first week saw long lines of eager early adopters flocking to Apple showrooms leading to short-term supply shortage. One of the biggest leaps Apple took was that unlike other manufacturers, iPad had done away with the use of a pressure triggered stylus, instead making the full multi touch screen workable with your fingers and with the virtual keyboard popping up wherever needed meant that a physical one could be dumped making the design more compact and portable.

On its first day itself the iPad sold 300,000 units and touched 3 million in 80 days. By April 2012 as per Apple's quarterly reports, almost 67 million units had been sold and with the latest model – the third generation iPad just hitting the market, sales are predicted to go higher than ever. So what was it that attracted people to Apple's newest offering? A combination of numerous factors working in its favor it would seem. It had the looks and the style to begin with, it had the perfect size to read documents,



Gesture recognition in the iPhone